



Minnehaha United
Methodist Church

Christmas Eve
Worship

December 24, 10:00pm





Minnehaha United Methodist Church

A Reconciling Congregation

We Seek, We Serve, We Celebrate

Welcome Friends!

We welcome you to worship wherever you may be in your faith's journey. We strive to live in the way of Jesus Christ, sharing God's love on a daily basis regardless of race, sexual orientation or faith history.

We livestream our worship services, and you may end up in view of the camera at any point in the service.

Worship Personnel

Rev. Becky Sechrist, *Pastor*;
Rev. Jean Elliott, *Director of Children, Youth, & Their Families*;
Anders Nelson, *Organist*;
Tim Siefkes, *Band Leader*;
Cindy Bergstrom, *Choir Director*;
Nicholas Sabah & John Davis, *Communion Stewards*

Minnehaha United Methodist Church acknowledges that we gather on the traditional, ancestral, and contemporary land of Dakota People.

Attendance

We are delighted you are here! We invite you to "sign the welcome pad" electronically.

If you point your camera phone at the QR code, it will take you to a Google form where you can enter your information.



Offering

For our offering, you can also give electronically through the PayPal account online, or by using this QR Code (which takes you to our PayPal account).



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December 24, 2025 10:00 p.m.

* Please rise in body or spirit

Children in Worship

We always welcome children in worship! We assume that they may make noise, wiggle, and even run around. The nursery, located on the 2nd floor, is available for parents to use if you'd like more room to move around and play. The worship service is live-streamed into the nursery. In addition, we have activity bags for children at the back of the sanctuary. Rocking chairs are also available for nursing or rocking at the back of the sanctuary and in the nursery.

Prelude

Anders Nelson, organ

Prelude on "Once in Royal David's City"

David Willcocks

Adeste Fideles (from 'Weinachtsbaum')

Anders Nelson and Jenny Ammerman, piano

Franz Liszt

Welcome

Lighting of the Advent Wreath

Anne and Hannah Scholen

Leader: Throughout the month of December, we have been preparing for this night.

People: **We began with the single candle of hope, a single flame bringing light into the darkness.**

Leader: We then lit the candle of peace, a daring prayer amidst the conflict in and all around us.

People: **As we lit the candle of peace, we were challenged to live lives of peace.**

Leader: Joy was our next candle, reminding us that even as the days get shorter, joy can reside in our souls

People: **We pledged to bring more joy in our own lives and into the lives of others.**

Leader: Just this last Sunday, we lit the candle of love.

People: **Love that sits as the source of our lives, love that motivates us to live lives as an expression of God's love.**

Leader: Tonight, we light the candle at the center, the Christ candle.

People: **May we know the good news that God comes to us in human form; unto us a child is born. A light shines in the darkness and the darkness cannot overcome it. Glory to God in the highest heaven!**

(light the candles of hope, peace, joy, love and the Christ Candle)

*Hymn

Good Christian Friends, Rejoice #224

The United Methodist Hymnal (red)

John Mason Neale (1855) Gary Alan Smith
Harm. © 1989 The United Methodist Publishing House.

Christmas Prayer

(adapted from Flames of the Spirit, ed. Ruth C. Duck)

Loving God, you have come to us, not with great signs and wonders, but in a babe who became a humble carpenter. You took on human form, not with the trappings of power and

might, but among folk who fasted, prayed, and gave thanks in the midst of their poverty. You sent Jesus to us from your very self, born as a human baby, to live among us and show us the way to new life. In response to your great labor of love, may we open ourselves to you, that you may create new life among us. Amen.

The Lord's Prayer

inclusive

Our Creator, God in heaven,
hallowed be thy name.
Thy kin-dom[✠] come, thy will be done,
on earth as it is in heaven.
Give us this day our daily bread.
And forgive us our trespasses as we forgive
those who trespass against us.
Lead us not into temptation,
but deliver us from evil.
For thine is the kin-dom and the power
and the glory forever. Amen.

[✠]Kin-dom represents a hope for God's realm where we are all in community with one another.

Anthem

Chancel Choir

1. Let all mortal flesh keep silence,
and with fear and trembling stand;
ponder nothing earthly minded,
for, with blessing in his hand,
Christ our God to earth descendeth,
our full homage to demand.

2. King of kings, yet born of Mary,
as of old on earth he stood,
Lord of lords, in human vesture,
in the body and the blood.
He will give to all the faithful
his own self for heav'nly food.

Let All Mortal Flesh Keep Silence

Gustav Holst (1906)

3. Rank on rank the host of heaven
spreads its vanguard on the way,
as the Light of light descendeth
from the realms of endless day,
that the pow'rs of hell may vanish
as the darkness clears away.

4. At his feet the six-winged seraph,
cherubim with sleepless eye,
veil their faces to the presence,
as with ceaseless voice they cry,
"Alleluia, alleluia,
alleluia, Lord Most High!"

~ translated from the Greek
by G. Moultrie

Reading

Isaiah 9:2, 6-7

David Hougen

Hymn

The United Methodist Hymnal (red)

The First Noel #245

traditional English carol; harm. from *Christmas Carols New and Old*, 1871

Reading

Luke 2:1-7

Anthem

My Lord Has Come

Will Todd

Shepherds, called by angels,
called by love and angels;
no place for them but a stable.
My Lord has come.

His love will hold me,
his love will cherish me,
love will cradle me.

Sages, searching for stars,
searching for love in heaven;
no place for them but a stable.
My Lord has come.

Lead me, lead me to see him,
sages and shepherds and angels;
no place for me but a stable.
My Lord has come.

Reading

Luke 2:8-20

Paula Barton

Hymn

The United Methodist Hymnal (red)

Angels From the Realms of Glory #220

James Montgomery (1816) Henry T. Smart (1867)

Sermon

“The Power of a Story”

Rev. Becky Sechrist

Anthem

Kristin Southworth, *soloist*

All Is Well

Michael W. Smith and Wayne Kirkpatrick, arr. Ronn Huff

*All is well, all is well.
Heaven and earth rejoice!
For tonight darkness fell
into the dawn of love's light.
Sing alleluia!*

*All is well, all is well.
Let there be peace on earth.
Christ is come, go and tell
that he is in the manger.
Sing alleluia!*

*All is well, all is well.
Lift up your voice and sing.
Born is now Emmanuel.
Born is our Lord and Savior.
Sing alleluia!
All is well.*

Reading

Psalm 96

Hymn

The United Methodist Hymnal (red)

There's a Song in the Air #249

Josiah G. Holland (1874) Karl P. Harrington (1904)

Offering of Gifts and Tithes Offertory Anthem

Were You There on That Christmas Night?

Natalie Sleeth

*Were you there, were you there
on that Christmas night,
when the world was filled
with a holy light?
Were you there to behold
when the wonder foretold came to earth?*

*Did you hear how the choir
of angels sang
at the glory of the sight?
Did you hear how the bells
of heaven rang
all through the night?*

*Did you see, did you see
how they hailed him King,
with the gifts so rare
that they chose to bring?
Did you see how they bowed,
as they praised him aloud at his birth?*

*Did you know, did you know
it was God's own Son,
the salvation of
the world begun?
Did you know it was love
that was sent from above to the earth?*

Prayer of Dedication

May these gifts of time, talent, and treasure proclaim your saving action in Jesus Christ. Through our offerings, empower this church to share the good news we have seen and heard. Equip us to sing with angels and run with shepherds. Fill us with your peace, that we may live more fully as peacemakers. Expand the horizons of our understanding and expectation, that we may move with confidence into these wider arenas where you call us to serve. Amen.

Hymn

The United Methodist Hymnal (red)

1. Silent night, holy night,
all is calm, all is bright
round yon virgin
mother and child.
Holy infant, so tender and mild,
sleep in heavenly peace,
sleep in heavenly peace.

2. Silent night, holy night,
shepherds quake at the sight;
glories stream from heaven afar,
heavenly hosts sing Alleluia!
Christ the Savior is born,
Christ the Savior is born!

Silent Night #239 (with candles)

Joseph Mohr, Franz Gruber (1818)

3. Silent night, holy night,
Son of God, love's pure light;
radiant beams from thy holy face
with the dawn of redeeming grace,
Jesus, Lord, at thy birth,
Jesus, Lord, at thy birth.

4. Silent night, holy night,
wondrous star, lend thy light;
with the angels let us sing,
Alleluia to our King;
Christ the Savior is born,
Christ the Savior is born!

Benediction

Postlude

Still, Still, Still

Paul Manz



WELCOME TO ALL VISITING THIS CHRISTMAS EVE!

We're so glad you're here. If you're seeking a church that feels like "home," we hope you'll consider Minnehaha United Methodist Church. We're a thriving multi-generational, multi-cultural congregation. Our Christian faith drives us to take action in our neighborhood through local missions, activism, and sharing the unconditional love of God with our neighbors. We make good things happen here.

We think you'll find ours a community that has a lot to offer:

- A place where **everyone is welcome**
- Faith development in a **positive, non-judgmental** way
- **Meaningful worship** with varied music styles at 9:30 a.m. and a monthly Taizé service (2nd Friday of the month)
- **Dynamic children & youth programs** with support for parents
- Lots of opportunities for **service to others**
- The opportunity for close, **life-long friendships**

To find out more, visit our website (www.minnehaha.org) or contact our pastor, Becky Sechrist (becky@minnehaha.org). Thank you for your visit. We hope you'll come back soon.

WINTER STUDIES

- Starting January 4, the Sunday morning Adult Faith Formation class (10:45 a.m.) will be exploring a series from Professor Dr. Amy Jill Levine on the Bible With and Without Jesus.
- Starting January 5, we'll be looking at different theological beliefs on Monday nights at 6:30 p.m. We'll start with concepts like original sin, being saved, and Jesus' second coming and then go on from there. This class will be offered in a hybrid style, so if you can't come in person, then join us utilizing the zoom link we'll have in our weekly enews (or contact becky@minnehaha.org for the link).

A colorful poster for the Minnehaha Youth Group. At the top center is a logo with a stylized 'm' in rainbow colors above the word 'MINNEHAHA' in green. Below this, 'YOUTH GROUP' is written in large blue letters, followed by 'Grades 6th-12th' in red script. The text 'SUNDAYS 4:00-5:30 PM' is in green. To the right is a circular photo of a group of youth. The background is light gray with colorful abstract shapes (purple, yellow, red, orange) and stars. At the bottom, it says 'Bring your snow gear on Jan. 4 & 18' in purple and 'No Youth Group on Jan. 25' in red.

MINNEHAHA
YOUTH GROUP
Grades 6th-12th
SUNDAYS
4:00-5:30 PM

*Come together for
weekly activities,
snacks, and fun in
community!*

Bring your snow gear on Jan. 4 & 18

No Youth Group on Jan. 25

POINSETTIAS

THIS CHRISTMAS EVE ARE GIVEN BY:

In celebration of Bryn, Harvey, and Hugo from Jenny & Dean Ammerman

In memory of our parents from Marshall & Margaret Cook

In Memory of LeeAnne Jasper from Cory Dallas

In memory of her brother, Kenneth Kittelson from Wanda Driver

In honor of Doreen Enge from Bud & Diane Enge

In memory of Manny & Arlene Forsberg and Bud Enge

In memory of Charles J. Graham from David Graham

In celebration of family from Sarah Hicks

In celebration of my 75 years at Minnehaha Church from Jan Hougen

In memory of Jerry Baste from Charlene & Craig Johnson

In celebration of our family near and far from Peter & Sue Johnson

In celebration of our grandchildren and great-grandchildren from Susan
& Arlo Johnson

In celebration of Viviana from Charlene & Craig Johnson

In honor of Thomas Nyseth from Rebecca Nyseth

In celebration of CRAFTS (Calista, Ryne, Amy, Francesca, Tyler, and Shane)
from Margaret Rawson

In memory of Bob & Barb Ellison from Patricia Roth

In memory of Joan Ellison from Patricia Roth

In honor of Rebecca Denison - HIV survivor/warrior from Jeanne Ritterson

In memory of Tom Brossart from Kristin & Jacob Southworth

For a more peaceful 2026 for all from Zane Thimmesch-Gill & Ani Goodenberger

In memory of Joyce Thompson from Gene Thompson



Minnehaha Winter Retreat January 23-25



Lake Koronis Assembly Grounds

Join us for a getaway weekend of winter fun!

Activities for All Ages

Friday Night Gathering

Saturday Morning Programs

-Adults -Youth -Children

Saturday Afternoon Freetime

Saturday Night Talent Show & Dance Party

Sunday Morning Worship

2 Lodging Options

Lakeview Lodge

Twin beds with shared bathrooms
down the hall

Sunrise Inn

Full sized beds with private
bathroom in the room

Register by Jan. 14



Winter Retreat Registration Link: <https://omella.com/c1pwd>